

# MEMO

## RE: SKILLS INITIATIVE FOR AFRICA (SIFA) FUND – SCHOLARX, ILORIN INNOVATION HUB AND IVTEC

ScholarX is an Education Technology (EdTech) company that focuses on democratising access to education amongst Africans. Launched in 2016, we have successfully managed over 50 million Naira worth of Scholarships and have onboarded over 200,000 students on our platform. Through AcadaFest, our widely attended fundraiser, we have raised over 10 million in tuition for Nigerians with an impressive 2 million views on our website.

We identified the gaps in EdTech adoption and have drawn a straight line to the low levels of digital inclusion in Nigeria. This led us to our latest project, LearnAM, which is an audio-digital platform that provides digital and vocational skills content for Nigerians. The app is bundled together with a device and given out at low interest loans to the users and was selected for the GSMA Innovation grant.

So far, we have focused on online education and skills training and have gotten tremendous results. We recently came across an opportunity to partner with the Ilorin Tech Innovation Hub and The International Vocational, Technical and Entrepreneurship College (IVTEC) to apply for a 3 million Euro grant. This grant is for the Skills Initiative for Africa (SIFA) and is given out by the African Union Development Agency (AUDA-NEPAD).

With the recent reduction in fees at the IVTEC, it is clear that this government is focused on encouraging education and enhancing the skills level of Nigerians leading them to entrepreneurship and thereby lifting them out of poverty.

To this end, we intend to partner with the renowned college to launch a project called “**The Hardware Assembly Re-skill Project (H.A.R.P.)**”. It is a Technical Vocational and Digital skills training project focusing on mobile device manufacturing and assembly. Offered, at the college, students learn valuable hardware skills which produces devices that can then be sold to the mass market.

The 3 million Euros fund will be used to set up a device manufacturing plant where students can enjoy hands-on learning experience in the college.

ScholarX, who through the successful implementation of LearnAM, has formed several strategic partnerships and brings the consortium to H.A.R.P. These partners include:

- REV – an indigenous licensed Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) set up to assemble learning and communication devices to bridge the mobile and digital gaps in Nigeria.
- Airtel Nigeria – a leading Mobile Network Operator (MNO) in Nigeria who provides bespoke and cheap data plans for users of LearnAM.
- VFD Microfinance Bank (Vbank) – who provides device debt financing for users at single digit interest.

This project will see that Kwara State is at the forefront of technological advancement in the country and will sit the Ilorin Innovation Hub in its rightful place as the home of everything ICT – both software and hardware.